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US, NATO seek to boost pressure on Putin

Push in Congress to punish Russia gains support as Trump, group's leader to meet

By Aamer Madhani
ASSOCIATED PRESS

BRIDGEWATER, N.J. — NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte is set to meet President Trump this week on the heels of the US leader announcing plans to sell NATO allies weaponry that they can then pass on to Ukraine.

NATO announced on Sunday that Rutte will be in Washington on Monday and Tuesday and would hold talks with Trump, Secretary of State Marco Rubio, and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, as well as members of Congress.

"I'm gonna have a meeting with the secretary general who's coming

in tomorrow," Trump told reporters Sunday night. "But we basically are going to send them various pieces of very sophisticated (weapons) and they're gonna pay us 100 percent for them."

Trump for months had threatened, but held off on, imposing new sanctions against Russia's oil industry. But the Republican leader has become increasingly exasperated with Vladimir Putin in recent days and has repeatedly laid into the Rus-

sian leader for prolonging the war.

"He talks so beautifully and then he'll bomb people at night," Trump said in his latest broadside against Putin. "We don't like that."

A top ally of Trump, Republican Senator Lindsey Graham of South Carolina, said Sunday the conflict is nearing an inflection point as Trump shows growing interest in helping Ukraine fight back Russia. It's a cause that Trump, who during

UKRAINE, Page A6

Job action upends courtroom dockets

Judges release defendants as lawyers demand pay raise; next, cases may be dropped

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

LOWELL — In courtrooms last week, lawyers were forced to do some quick math with high stakes.

The public defenders in Lowell District Court already had a heavy caseload but used two of their remaining slots for the most serious cases: one man accused of child rape, and another charged with gun offenses and domestic violence.

If the public defenders had not done so, Judge John Coffey may have been forced to release them rather than keep them in jail — a new crisis facing judges in Suffolk and Middlesex counties amid an ongoing work stoppage by court-appointed private attorneys.

It's a conundrum arising from a system that is unique to Massachusetts and a handful of other states and that is at the mercy of the state Legislature. Roughly 80 percent of indigent defendants in Massachusetts are represented by private attorneys, known as bar advocates, with the remaining staffed by attorneys at the Committee for Public Counsel Services. So the bar advocates' refusal to take on new clients until they receive a pay raise from the Legislature has effectively crippled the courts' ability to proceed with those cases.

BAR ADVOCATES, Page A7

Foundations try to plug holes as grants sliced

Private groups run risks as they turn distress into joy for several local nonprofits

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

On a Friday night in early May, Kara Matthews, director of development at the Fuller Craft Museum in Brockton, received an email that left her fuming.

It said a \$10,000 National Endowment for the Arts grant the museum had been promised months ago was canceled because their project did not align with the priorities of President Trump.

Matthews anxiously scrambled to find a financial solution for the nonprofit, which had already spent the money in anticipation of receiving the grant. "We're a midsized employer with a group of people whose families rely on the income that they get from this museum," she said.

Just days later, Matthews's anger turned to tears of joy when she learned the Warhol Foundation and Frankenthaler Foundation were offering \$800,000 to make her organization — and 79 others across the country with canceled NEA grants — whole.

FOUNDATIONS, Page A7



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Cassandra Xavier, who is visually impaired, says she has difficulty using her cane when sidewalks are rough and in need of fixes.

For some, city sidewalks still rugged terrain

Disabled pedestrians say Boston remains out of step on safety, access concerns

By Emily Spatz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Jake Haendel never thought much about how hard it is to get around in Boston until 2017, when he was diagnosed with a brain disease that left him reliant on a motorized scooter. Haendel now experiences mobility challenges right in the open, scattered across miles of Boston sidewalks.

"This is the same city I used to go around, and now it's like a light switch has been turned on and I just notice that stuff everywhere," Haendel said.

Four years after Boston settled a lawsuit intended to improve sidewalk accessibility, the city has come up short — every year, since — of the 1,630 curb ramp repairs it agreed to make, city data show. Although prog-



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

ress is being made, the closest it came to meeting its obligation was in 2022, when Boston, a centuries-old city that wasn't built with modern accessibility in mind, repaired 1,586 ramps. It's averaged about 1,300 repairs a year.

Beyond curb ramps, Boston's sidewalks are also not easy for everyone to maneuver.

According to a Globe review of city data, roughly 5,700 reports of sidewalk defects were made to the phone number 311 in 2024, some of which were closed

SIDEWALKS, Page A10

Chris Hoeh often has to travel on the roads when the sidewalks are blocked or unable to be accessed.

For sale: a site where patriots got paychecks

Ebenezer Hancock House has seen triumphs and times that try men's soles

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

The house was headquarters for a Continental Army's paymaster during the American Revolution. It was once owned by a founding father, and for years, the country's oldest continuously run shoe store occupied the first floor.

Dating to 1767, the Ebenezer Hancock House at 10 Marshall St., right by Haymarket, is chock full of history and thought to be the only house left in downtown Boston built during the period of the American Revolution, according to one city architect.

And it's for sale. "The interior detail that's survived, you can't replicate it," said Dave Killen, a commercial real estate broker for LandVest who is selling the property for the owners, the Swartz family.

The law firm of Swartz & Swartz bought the Hancock House after "it was left vacant following a serious car accident in the 1970s, which nearly destroyed the storefront at the corner of the building," according to the book "Boston's Oldest Buildings and Where to Find Them," by Joseph M. Bagley, a city archeologist.

The house is the 27th oldest building of any kind in Boston,

HANCOCK HOUSE, Page A10



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

John Hancock built the Ebenezer Hancock House at 10 Marshall Street in Boston.



Go fry a kite

Monday: Thunderstorms late. High 80-85, low 70-75.

Tuesday: Warmer, hazy. High 86-91, low 69-74.

Sunrise: 5:20. Sunset: 8:20.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Protesters in Haverhill denounced police actions following the death of a man during a struggle with officers. B1.

A steady erosion of experienced staff is compromising the work of the Food and Drug Administration, current and former employees say. D1.

Another series, another sweep for the Red Sox as they take 10 in a row heading into the All-Star Game break. **C1.**

Jannik Sinner claimed his first Wimbledon title, beating Carlos Alcaraz in four sets in a gripping, four-set Grand Slam final. **C1.**

Rains once more inundated parts of Texas, suspending some search operations following the flooding disaster along the Guadalupe River. **A2.**

